

## TEST FOR ACID RAIN

Here is an experiment you can use to test for acid in rainwater. You will need two finely chopped red cabbage leaves, distilled water (from a pharmacy), rainwater, a bowl, two glass jars, a measuring cup, and a sieve.



1. Put the leaves into the bowl. Have an adult pour hot distilled water over them. Then let them stand for an hour.



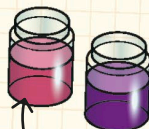
2. Strain the cabbage juice into a measuring cup. The liquid should be a dark purple color.



3. Pour 1 fl oz (20 ml) of distilled water into one jar, and 1 fl oz (20 ml) of rainwater, collected from your yard, into the other.

4. Add the same amount of cabbage juice to each jar. The water will change color. Compare the color of the distilled water (this stays the same) and the rainwater. If the rainwater turns red, it is acidic.

Rainwater

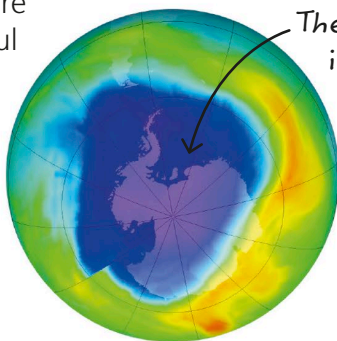


Distilled water

The stronger the acid, the redder the water gets.

## The Earth's blanket

The ozone layer of our atmosphere protects us from the Sun's harmful ultraviolet rays. However, some chemicals can destroy it. As a result, holes have appeared in the ozone layer, allowing more of the harmful rays to reach the Earth's surface and damage many living things.



The blue areas in this satellite photograph show the hole in the ozone layer over the Antarctic.